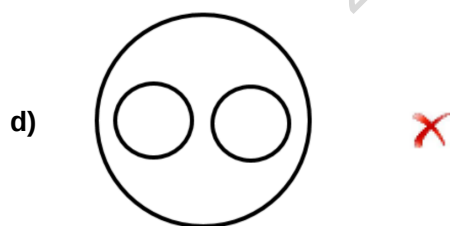
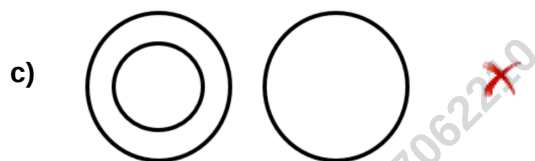
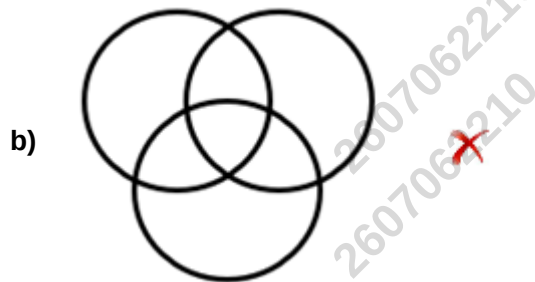
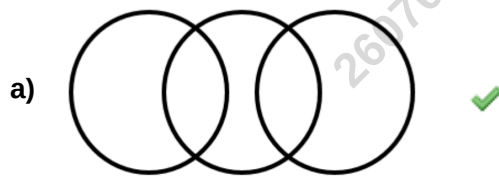


RBE SSC CGL Tier-1 Live Mock 24, July 05, 2026

Q. 1	Complete the following series: 27, 125, 343, 729, ____. a) 1000 b) 1728 c) 1331 d) 2197
Explanation:	Explanation: The given series is: 27, 125, 343, 729 • $27 = 3^3$ • $125 = 5^3$ • $343 = 7^3$ • $729 = 9^3$ Pattern: Cubes of consecutive odd numbers (3, 5, 7, 9, ...) Next number = $11^3 = 1331$

Q. 2

Which of the following diagrams indicates the best relation between Travelers, Train and Bus?



Explanation:

Diagram logic:

- One circle for **Travelers**
- Two separate circles for **Train** and **Bus**
- Both Train and Bus circles **partially overlap with Travelers**, but **not with each other**

This represents the real relationship correctly.

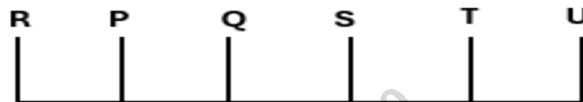
Q. 3

Six friends P, Q, R, S, T, and U, are sitting in a straight line facing north. Q is to the immediate right of P. R and U are both at one of the ends. T is sitting between S and U. S is not sitting next to P. Who is sitting in the second position from the left?

- a) T 
- b) Q 
- c) P 
- d) S 

Explanation:

NORTH



P is sitting to the second position from the left.

Q. 4

A pair of numbers is given that follows a particular logic or pattern. Examine the relationship between them and select the option that reflects the same kind of relationship in its pair.

6 : 246 :: 8 : ?

- a) 536 
- b) 534 
- c) 548 
- d) 568 

Explanation:

Pattern: $(n^3 + n^2 - n)$

Check for 6:

$$(6^3 + 6^2 - 6 = 216 + 36 - 6 = 246) \checkmark$$

Now for 8:

$$(8^3 + 8^2 - 8 = 512 + 64 - 8 = 568)$$

 Answer: 568 (Option 4)



Q. 5

In each question, a relationship between different elements is shown in the statements. The statements are followed by conclusions. Study the conclusions based on the given statements and select the appropriate answer.

$$A > B = C \leq D < E \geq F$$

Conclusions:

$$A > C$$

$$E > B$$

$$D \geq F$$

a) Only I follows

b) Only II and III follow

c) Only I and II follow

d) All follow

Conclusion I: $A > C$

From the statement, $A > B$ and $B = C$

So, if B and C are equal, then $A > C$

Therefore, **Conclusion I follows.**

Conclusion II: $E > B$

From the statement, $B = C$ and $C \leq D < E$

This means E is greater than D , and D is greater than or equal to C

So, $E > C$

Since $B = C$, therefore $E > B$

Hence, **Conclusion II also follows.**

Conclusion III: $D \geq F$

From the statement, $D < E$ and $E \geq F$

Here, we only know that E is greater than or equal to F , but no definite relation is given between D and F

It is possible that:

- $D > F$, or
- $D = F$, or
- $D < F$

So, $D \geq F$ is not definitely true

Therefore, **Conclusion III does not follow.**

Final Answer:

Only I and II follow

Explanation:

Q. 6

Out of 96 students, boys are three times the number of girls. Rahul is ranked 25th from the top. There are 12 girls ahead of him. How many boys are after Rahul?

- a) 60 
- b) 59 
- c) 61 
- d) 62 

Explanation:

Total students = 96

Let girls = x , boys = $3x$

$$\Rightarrow x + 3x = 96$$

$$\Rightarrow 4x = 96$$

$$\Rightarrow x = 24$$

So, Girls = 24, Boys = 72

Rahul is **25th from top**

$\Rightarrow$ Students ahead of him = 24

Out of these 24, **12 are girls**

$\Rightarrow$ Boys ahead of Rahul = $24 - 12 = 12$

Remaining girls = $24 - 12 = 12$

Students after Rahul = $96 - 25 = 71$

Girls after Rahul = 12

$\Rightarrow$ Boys after Rahul = $71 - 12 = 59$

Explanation:

Q. 7

Two students—P who is facing north and Q who is facing south—received the following commands from their Physical Trainer: Right Turn, About Turn, Left Turn, Right Turn. Which directions would P and Q face respectively at the end?

a) North, South



b) East, West



c) South, North



d) West, East

**Explanation:**

Initial directions:

P → North

Q → South

Apply commands step-by-step:

1. Right Turn

- P: North → East
- Q: South → West

2. About Turn (180° turn)

- P: East → West
- Q: West → East

3. Left Turn

- P: West → South
- Q: East → North

4. Right Turn

- P: South → West
- Q: North → East

👉 Final directions:

P = West, Q = East

Q. 8	If 1st February 2024 is a Thursday, what day is 1st April 2024? a) Sunday  b) Monday  c) Tuesday  d) Wednesday 
Explanation:	Explanation: 1st February 2024 = Thursday February 2024 is a leap year month → 29 days $29 \div 7 = 4 \text{ weeks} + 1 \text{ extra day}$ 👉 So, 1st March 2024 = Thursday + 1 = Friday March has 31 days $31 \div 7 = 4 \text{ weeks} + 3 \text{ extra days}$ 👉 So, 1st April 2024 = Friday + 3 = Monday
Q. 9	eShram is to Unorganised Workers as SWAYAM is to...? a) Construction Workers  b) Skill Mapping  c) Online Learning  d) Pensions 
Explanation:	Explanation: • eShram portal is meant for unorganised workers for their registration and welfare benefits. • Similarly, SWAYAM is a government platform for online education/learning. • It provides free courses, digital learning content, and skill development. • Hence, the correct analogy is SWAYAM → Online Learning.

Q. 10	If FLOWER is coded as GMPXFS, how will GARDEN be coded? a) HBSEOF  b) HSBFO  c) HBSFEO  d) HBSEFO 
Explanation:	Explanation: FLOWER → GMPXFS ⇒ each letter is +1 forward GARDEN: G → H A → B R → S D → E E → F N → O Code = HBSEFO

Q. 11

Introducing a woman, Prem said, "She is the mother of my father's granddaughter." How is the woman related to Prem?

a) Mother of Prem

b) Sister of Prem

c) Wife of Prem

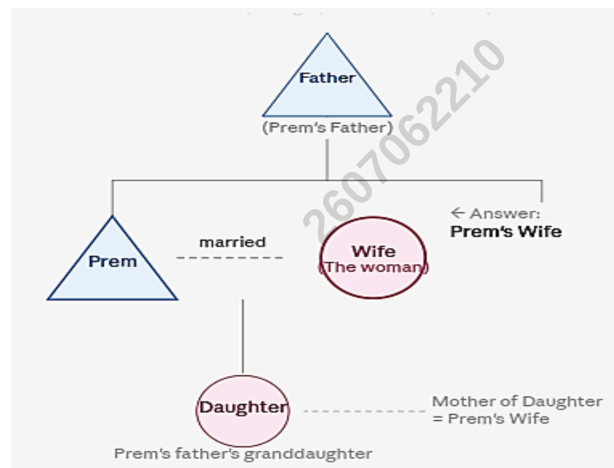
d) Aunt of Prem

Explanation:

Father's granddaughter = Prem's daughter

Mother of that granddaughter = Prem's wife

Hence, the woman is **Prem's wife**

Explanation:

Q. 12

Pick a figure from Image Y that fits as the next step in the sequence in Image X.

Image X:

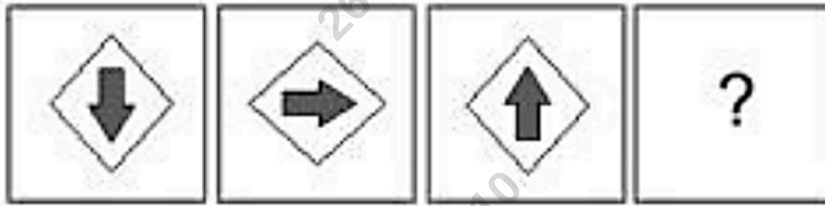
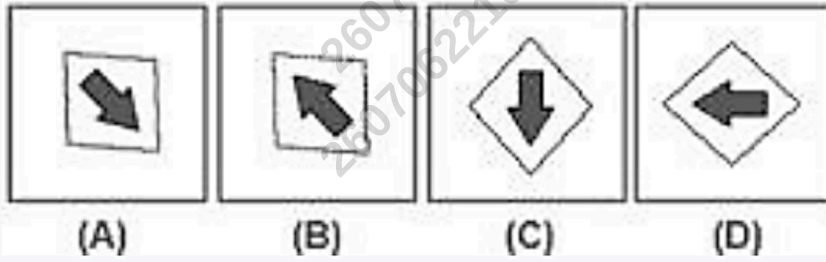
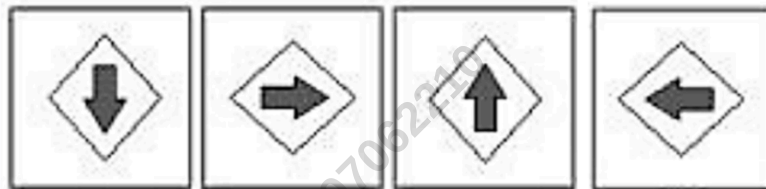


Image Y:



- a) A ☐
- b) B ☐
- c) C ☐
- d) D ☒

Explanation:



Pattern: Arrow rotates 90° anti-clockwise each step

Q. 13

Find the odd one from the group.

- a) London 
- b) Kiev 
- c) Paris 
- d) Belarus 

Explanation:

Explanation:

- London, Kiev, and Paris are **capital cities**.
- Belarus is a **country**, not a capital city.

Hence, **Belarus** is the odd one out.

Q. 14

Choose the correct logical and meaningful order of the words:

1. Line
2. Triangle
3. Angle
4. Point
- a) 1342 
- b) 1423 
- c) 4132 
- d) 4123 

Explanation:

Explanation:

Point → Line → Angle → Triangle

- A **point** is the basic unit.
- A **line** is formed by joining points.
- An **angle** is formed by two lines.
- A **triangle** is formed using angles/lines.

Hence, correct order = 4 → 1 → 3 → 2 = 4132

Q. 15

If '+' stands for multiplication, '-' stands for addition, '×' stands for division, and '÷' stands for subtraction, then which one of the following equations is correct?

$$48 + 6 \times 3 - 8 \div 2 = ?$$

a) 94



b) 98



c) 102



d) 104

**Explanation:****Explanation:**

Given:

$$48 + 6 \times 3 - 8 \div 2$$

After replacing symbols:

$$48 \times 6 \div 3 + 8 - 2$$

Solve:

$$48 \times 6 = 288$$

$$288 \div 3 = 96$$

$$96 + 8 = 104$$

$$104 - 2 = \mathbf{102}$$

Q. 17

Replace the question mark (?) in the series given below:

78, 79, 83, 101, 197, ?

a) 547



b) 642



c) 797



d) 834



Explanation:

Logic: Add $n \times n!$

$$78 + 1 \times 1! = 79$$

$$79 + 2 \times 2! = 83$$

$$83 + 3 \times 3! = 101$$

$$101 + 4 \times 4! = 197$$

$$197 + 5 \times 5! = 197 + 600 = 797$$

Answer: 797 (Option 3)

Q. 18

Find the odd one from the group.

a) docx



b) exe



c) ppt



d) pdf



Explanation:

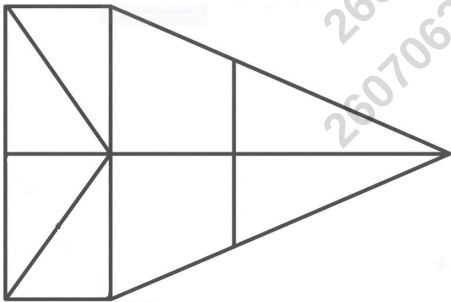
Explanation:

- docx, ppt, and pdf are **document/file formats**.
- exe is an **executable file (program/application)**.

Hence, **exe** is the odd one out.

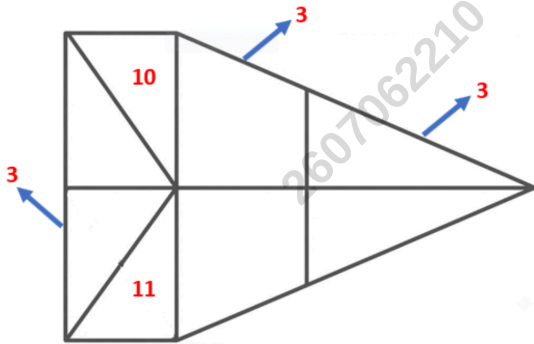
Q. 19

How many triangles are there in the given figure?



- a) 8 ☐
- b) 9 ☐
- c) 11 ☒
- d) 12 ☐

Explanation:



Q. 20

In the word DEMONSTRATION, what is the second letter to the right of the 3rd letter to the left of the 5th letter from the right?

- a) T ☐
- b) R ☒
- c) A ☐
- d) I ☐

Explanation:

Explanation:
DEMONSTRATION
5th letter from right = A
3rd letter to the left of A = S
2nd letter to the right of S = R

Q. 21	Dog is to Bark as Cat is to...? a) Run  b) Sleep  c) Meow  d) Jump 
Explanation:	Explanation: • Bark is the sound made by a dog. • Similarly, meow is the sound made by a cat. Hence, the correct answer is Meow.
Q. 22	In a team video call, one member's connectivity is poor and repeats questions you already answered. What is the socially intelligent response? a) Answer patiently again  b) Tell them to check the recording later  c) Ignore their questions  d) Say they are wasting time 
Explanation:	Explanation: • A socially intelligent person shows patience and empathy. • Poor connectivity is not the member's fault. • Repeating the answer helps maintain team coordination and respect. Hence, the correct answer is Answer patiently again.

Q. 23

In the following questions, a few statements are given, followed by some conclusions. Consider the statements to be true, even if they appear to contradict commonly known facts. Read all the conclusions carefully and decide which of them logically follows from the given statements.

Statements:

All lions are animals.

Some animals are birds.

No bird is a fish.

Conclusions:

I. Some lions are birds.

II. Some animals are fish.

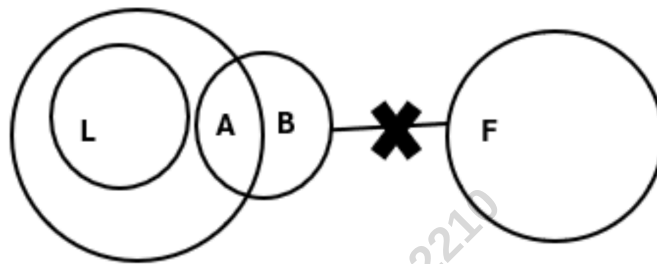
III. No fish is a bird.

a) Only III follows ✓

b) Only II follows ✗

c) Only I and III follow ✗

d) None follows ✗



Explanation:

Explanation:

- **Conclusion I: Some lions are birds → Does NOT follow**
 - Given: All lions are animals, and some animals are birds
 - But there is **no direct link** between lions and birds
 - So we cannot say lions are birds ✗
- **Conclusion II: Some animals are fish → Does NOT follow**
 - Given: Some animals are birds, and no bird is a fish
 - There is **no information connecting animals with fish**
 - So this cannot be concluded ✗
- **Conclusion III: No fish is a bird → Follows**
 - Given: No bird is a fish
 - This can be **reversed (conversion rule)** → No fish is a bird ✓

Hence, **only Conclusion III follows.**

Q. 24	In the following, four roll numbers or centre codes are given. Three share a common pattern or belong to one group, but one is different. Select the odd one out. 310245, 310678, 310912, 420356 a) 310245 ✗ b) 310678 ✗ c) 310912 ✗ d) 420356 ✓
Explanation:	Explanation: - Three numbers start with 310 → 310245, 310678, 310912 ✓ - Only one number starts with 420 → 420356 ✗ - Hence, 420356 is different from the others.
Q. 25	Complete the analogy. Photosynthesis : Chlorophyll :: Hearing : ? a) Bone ✗ b) Veins ✗ c) Voice ✗ d) Cochlea ✓
Explanation:	Explanation: Chlorophyll is the main component that helps in photosynthesis. - Similarly, cochlea is the main organ responsible for hearing. - Hence, the correct answer is Cochlea. Important Facts - The ear has three parts: outer ear, middle ear, and inner ear. - The cochlea is a spiral-shaped structure present in the inner ear. - It converts sound vibrations into nerve signals, which are sent to the brain. - That is why it plays a key role in hearing.

Q. 26	Which Five Year Plan aimed to establish a socialist pattern of society in India? a) Second Plan (1956–61) ✓ b) First Plan (1951–56) ✗ c) Fourth Plan (1969–74) ✗ d) Third Plan (1961–66) ✗
Explanation:	Answer: Second Five Year Plan (1956–61) • Introduced P.C. Mahalanobis Model • Focus on rapid industrialization • Priority to heavy industries (steel, coal, machinery) • Strong public sector dominance • Aim: Build a socialist pattern of society (reduce inequality + planned economy) • First Plan: Agriculture & food security • Third Plan: Balanced growth + self-reliance • Fourth Plan: Stability + poverty reduction Final Answer: Second Five Year Plan (1956–61)

Q. 27	Consider the following statements: 1. The Eastern Ghats and Western Ghats meet at the Nilgiri Hills. 2. The Thar Desert is the most densely populated desert in the world. 3. The Patkai or Purvanchal ranges are a part of the Eastern Himalayas. 4. The Satpura range is formed by a series of scarped plateaus on the south, generally at an elevation varying between 300–400 m above mean sea level. Which of the statements above are correct? a) 1, 3 and 4 only  b) 1, 2 and 3 only  c) 2, 3 and 4 only  d) 1, 2 and 4 only 
Explanation:	Answer: (b) 1, 2 and 3 only Explanation: Statement 1: Correct – Eastern Ghats and Western Ghats meet at Nilgiri Hills, forming a junction of two major mountain ranges in South India. Statement 2: Correct – Thar Desert is the most densely populated desert in the world due to availability of water sources and settlements in Rajasthan. Statement 3: Correct – Patkai or Purvanchal ranges are part of the Eastern Himalayas located in the northeastern region of India. Statement 4: Incorrect – Satpura range is a block mountain system formed due to faulting, not a series of scarped plateaus. Conclusion: Statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct, while statement 4 is incorrect. Hence, the correct answer is (b).

Q. 28	Which of the following statements is NOT TRUE about Rash Behari Bose? a) He founded Indian Independence League in Tokyo in 1942.  b) He was an important figure in the Ghadar Movement and in the formation of the Azad Hind Fauj.  c) He was honoured with the prestigious title 'Order of the Rising Sun'.  d) He was Independent India's first Commander-in-Chief of Indian Army. 
Explanation:	(A): Correct – Rash Behari Bose played a key role in forming the Indian Independence League in Tokyo (1942) to mobilize Indians abroad. (B): Correct – He was associated with revolutionary activities, influenced the Ghadar Movement, and helped in early formation efforts of Azad Hind Fauj. (C): Correct – He was awarded Japan's honour "Order of the Rising Sun" for his contribution to Indo-Japanese relations and independence efforts. (D): Incorrect – He was NOT Independent India's first Commander-in-Chief; this post was held by General K.M. Cariappa (first Indian Commander-in-Chief after independence). Final Answer: (D)

Q. 29	Which of the following is NOT a feature of India's federal system, thereby reflecting its unitary character? a) Requirement of some Constitutional Amendments to be ratified by States  b) An upper house of Parliament (Rajya Sabha) representing the states  c) Single citizenship for the entire country  d) Division of powers between the Centre and States 
Explanation:	Answer: (C) Single citizenship for the entire country Explanation: (A): This is a federal feature because some constitutional amendments require approval of states, showing shared power. (B): Rajya Sabha represents states, which is a strong federal feature. (C): Correct answer. Single citizenship is a unitary feature, not federal, as it does not give separate citizenship to states. (D): Division of powers between Centre and States is a core federal principle. Conclusion: India has a quasi-federal system, and single citizenship reflects its unitary character.

Q. 30	Which of the following correctly describes Mission Shakti? 1.It is an integrated women empowerment programme launched in 2022. 2.It is run by the Ministry of Women and Child Development. 3.The scheme includes Samarthya and Sambal sub-schemes. a) All 1, 2 and 3 are correct ✓ b) Only 1 and 3 are correct ✗ c) Only 2 and 3 are correct ✗ d) Only 1 and 2 are correct ✗
Explanation:	All three statements correctly describe Mission Shakti. Therefore, statements 1, 2, and 3 are all correct. Explanation: ✓ Statement 1 is correct: Mission Shakti is an integrated umbrella women empowerment programme. The Government of India introduced its operational norms with effect from April 1, 2022, to run through the 15th Finance Commission period. ✓ Statement 2 is correct: The scheme is implemented and run by the Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD). It serves as the nodal agency for converging various women's safety and welfare policies. ✓ Statement 3 is correct: The scheme is split structurally into two key sub-schemes or verticals: Sambal (dedicated to safety and security) and Samarthya (dedicated to socio-economic empowerment).

Q. 31	Consider the following statements: - Article 263 empowers Parliament to establish an Inter-State Council. - The Council can investigate inter-state disputes. - Its composition includes the Prime Minister and Union Ministers. Which of the above statements is/are correct? a) 2 and 3 only  b) 1 and 2 only  c) 1 and 3 only  d) 1, 2 and 3 All 
Explanation:	Answer: (A) 2 and 3 only Explanation: Statement 1: Incorrect – Article 263 empowers the President, not Parliament, to establish an Inter-State Council. Statement 2: Correct – The Inter-State Council can investigate and discuss inter-state disputes for better coordination. Statement 3: Correct – Its composition includes the Prime Minister (Chairman) and Union Ministers (along with Chief Ministers of states). Final Answer: 2 and 3 only
Q. 32	A group of ribosomes attached to mRNA is known as ____. a) Polypeptide  b) Polysomes  c) Polymer  d) Monomer 
Explanation:	When multiple ribosomes simultaneously attach to a single mRNA molecule and translate it at the same time, this structure is called polysomes (polyribosomes). It helps in faster protein synthesis because one mRNA produces many protein copies at once. Polypeptide: A chain of amino acids formed during protein synthesis, not ribosomes. Polymer: A large molecule made of repeating units (monomers), not related to ribosome grouping. Monomer: The smallest basic unit of a polymer, not related to ribosomes.

Q. 33	Rusting of iron is an example of: a) Decomposition reaction ✗ b) Oxidation reaction ✓ c) Reduction reaction ✗ d) Displacement reaction ✗
Explanation:	Answer: B. Oxidation reaction Explanation : A. Decomposition reaction → One compound breaks into simpler substances → Example: $\text{CaCO}_3 \rightarrow \text{CaO} + \text{CO}_2 \rightarrow$ ✗ Not rusting B. Oxidation reaction → Iron + Oxygen + Water → Iron oxide (Rust) → $\text{Fe} + \text{O}_2 + \text{H}_2\text{O} \rightarrow \text{Fe}_2\text{O}_3$ (Rust) → ✓ Correct C. Reduction reaction → Gain of hydrogen / loss of oxygen → ✗ Rusting involves gain of oxygen, not loss D. Displacement reaction → One metal replaces another metal in compound → Example: $\text{Zn} + \text{CuSO}_4 \rightarrow \text{ZnSO}_4 + \text{Cu} \rightarrow$ ✗ Not rusting ✓ Final Concept: Rusting = Oxidation ($\text{Fe} + \text{O}_2 + \text{H}_2\text{O} \rightarrow \text{Rust}$)
Q. 34	In which year did India first participate in the Olympic Games? a) 1900 ✓ b) 1920 ✗ c) 1924 ✗ d) 1928 ✗
	Answer: A. 1900 Answer Explanation: India's first Olympic participation was in the 1900 Paris Olympics, where athlete Norman Pritchard represented India in athletics events. This was the first appearance of India in modern Olympic history. Option Explanation: 1900 → Correct year when India first participated in Olympics through Norman Pritchard 1920 → First official Indian Olympic team participated as a national contingent 1924 → India participated in Paris Olympics in athletics and tennis events 1928 → India won its first Olympic gold medal in Hockey as a team sport

Q. 35	The Tamil word “muvendar” mentioned in the Sangam poems means — a) Dhamma Mahamatta ✗ b) Headmen ✗ c) Rich ✗ d) Three chiefs ✓
Explanation:	Answer: (d) Three chiefs Explanation: (a) Dhamma Mahamatta: These were officials appointed by Ashoka to spread Dhamma, not related to Sangam polity. (b) Headmen: Village-level leaders, not connected with the term “muvendar”. (c) Rich: Incorrect meaning, not related to Sangam literature usage. (d) Three chiefs: Correct. “Muvendar” refers to the three major Tamil ruling dynasties – Cheras, Cholas, and Pandyas mentioned in Sangam literature. Final Answer: Three chiefs
Q. 36	Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana is famous for which style of singing? a) Light music ✗ b) Complex raga structure and rare ragas ✓ c) Folk music ✗ d) Bhajans only ✗
Explanation:	Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana is known for its complex and rare ragas and highly structured classical singing style, especially its intricate use of melody, mathematical precision in raga development, and emphasis on purity of classical traditions.

Q. 37	Consider the following statements: 1. Elements cannot be broken into simpler substances by chemical means. 2. Compounds are made of only one type of atom. 3. Hydrogen is the lightest element. 4. Oxygen supports combustion. Which of the statements is/are CORRECT? a) 1, 3 and 4 only  b) 1 and 2 only  c) 2 and 3 only  d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 All 
Explanation:	Answer: (a) 1, 3 and 4 only Explanation (1): Correct – Elements are pure substances that cannot be broken into simpler substances by chemical reactions. (2): Incorrect – Compounds are made of two or more different elements, not a single type of atom. (3): Correct – Hydrogen is the lightest element in the periodic table. (4): Correct – Oxygen supports combustion but is not itself combustible.

Q. 38	Consider the following statements: 1. The Production Possibility Frontier (PPF) shows the trade-offs and opportunity costs faced by an economy. 2. The PPF is used to estimate the government's total revenue and expenditure. Which of the above statements is/are correct? a) Only Statement 1 is correct ✓ b) Only Statement 2 is correct ✗ c) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct ✗ d) Neither Statement 1 nor Statement 2 is correct ✗
Explanation:	Answer: (a) Only Statement 1 is correct Explanation Statement 1: Correct – PPF shows different combinations of goods an economy can produce and highlights trade-offs and opportunity cost due to limited resources. Statement 2: Incorrect – PPF has nothing to do with government revenue or expenditure; it is a microeconomic production concept, not fiscal accounting.

Q. 39

Article 131A was repealed by which Constitutional Amendment?

a) 42nd Amendment



b) 44th Amendment



c) 43rd Amendment



d) 45th Amendment

**Article 131A**

Article 131A was inserted by the **42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976**.

It gave **exclusive jurisdiction to the Supreme Court** in cases related to the **constitutional validity of Central laws**, meaning only the Supreme Court could decide such matters.

Later, this provision was considered restrictive and unnecessary, so it was **repealed by the 43rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1977**, restoring normal judicial review powers.

Explanation:**Option-wise Explanation**

(a) **42nd Amendment:** Inserted Article 131A, not repealed it

(b) **44th Amendment:** Related to emergency provisions and protection of fundamental rights

(c) **43rd Amendment:** Repealed Article 131A ✓

(d) **45th Amendment:** Extended reservation provisions for SC/ST

Final Answer: 43rd Constitutional Amendment Act (1977)

Q. 40	Lehmann's discontinuity is — a) The boundary between crust and mantle  b) The boundary between mantle and core  c) The boundary between inner core and outer core  d) The boundary between upper and lower mantle 
Explanation:	Answer: (c) The boundary between inner core and outer core Explanation: (a) Crust–mantle boundary is called Moho discontinuity (b) Mantle–core boundary is called Gutenberg discontinuity (c) Inner core–outer core boundary is called Lehmann discontinuity (correct) (d) Upper–lower mantle boundary is called Repetti discontinuity
Q. 41	Which of the following is NOT one of the monarchical states that existed in the 7th and early 6th centuries BC in India? a) Magadha  b) Vaishali  c) Avanti  d) Kosala 
Explanation:	Answer: (b) Vaishali Explanation: (a) Magadha: A powerful monarchical mahajanapada located in eastern India, ruled by dynasties like Haryanka and later Maurya foundations. (b) Vaishali: This was a Gana-Sangha (oligarchic republic), not a monarchy, ruled by a group of chiefs (Licchavis), hence it is the correct answer. (c) Avanti: A strong monarchical kingdom in western India with its capital at Ujjain. (d) Kosala: A major monarchical state in northern India, known for its powerful rulers and connection with Ayodhya region.

Q. 42

Which of the following animals was a part of the Indian Army's animal contingent at the Republic Day Parade 2026?

1. Bactrian camels

2. Zanskar ponies

3. Army dogs

4. Elephants

a) 1, 2 and 3 only



b) 1 and 4 only



c) 2 and 3 only



d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 All



Explanation:

At the 2026 Republic Day Parade on Kartavya Path, the Indian Army debuted a newly curated animal contingent from the Remount and Veterinary Corps (RVC). This specific contingent included **Bactrian camels**, **Zanskar ponies**, **Army dogs**, and trained raptors (birds of prey). **Elephants** were not a part of this Indian Army animal contingent.

Breakdown of the Options

-  **1. Bactrian camels (Correct):** Double-humped Bactrian camels from Ladakh made a historic debut to showcase their role in cold desert military operations.
-  **2. Zanskar ponies (Correct):** This rare and indigenous mountain breed was featured for its incredible endurance in high-altitude logistics and Siachen Glacier deployments.
-  **3. Army dogs (Correct):** The squad showcased both conventional military canines and indigenously-bred Indian dogs (such as the Mudhol Hound and Rampur Hound) equipped with operational gear.
-  **4. Elephants (Incorrect):** While elephants were historically a traditional part of Republic Day Parades decades ago, they were not included in the 2026 Indian Army animal contingent.

Q. 43	Which river rises near Mhow in the Malwa plateau of Madhya Pradesh? a) Chambal  b) Mahi  c) Varuna  d) Betwa 
Explanation:	Answer: (a) Chambal Explanation: Chambal: Rises near Janapav Hills (Mhow, Malwa plateau), tributary of Yamuna, famous for deep ravines and badland topography, relatively pollution-free river. Mahi: Originates in Vindhya range (Dhar region MP), flows through MP–Rajasthan–Gujarat and drains into Arabian Sea. Varuna: Small river in Uttar Pradesh, tributary of Ganga near Varanasi region. Betwa: Originates near Raisen district (MP), tributary of Yamuna, important river of Bundelkhand region. Final Answer: Chambal

Q. 44	Consider the following statements about Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves: 1. These caves are near Bhubaneswar and were meant for Jain monks. 2. All caves are shaped like flowers and are carved from independent boulders. 3. Each cave has multiple shrines dedicated to different Buddhist deities. Which of the above statements is/are correct? a) Only 1  b) All of these  c) 1 and 2 only  d) 2 and 3 only 
Explanation:	Statements about Udayagiri & Khandagiri caves: 1.  Correct → Located near Bhubaneswar and associated with Jain monks 2.  Incorrect → Not all caves are flower-shaped; they are rock-cut caves, not independent boulders 3.  Incorrect → These are Jain caves, not Buddhist shrines ✓ Final Answer: Only statement 1 is correct

Q. 45	Which of the following correctly reflects the legal implication of Article 255 regarding presidential or governor's assent to bills? a) State law is void without written Governor assent.  b) Mention of assent is mandatory for validity  c) Omission of prior recommendation doesn't invalidate law if assent is given.  d) President's assent must precede legislative passage to be valid. 
Explanation:	Answer: (C) Omission of prior recommendation doesn't invalidate law if assent is given. Explanation: A: Incorrect – A state law is not automatically void due to absence of such mention; validity depends on constitutional procedure. B: Incorrect – Mention of assent is not a mandatory condition for validity if constitutional requirements are otherwise fulfilled. C: Correct – Article 255 provides that omission of prior recommendation or procedural requirements does not invalidate a law once assent is properly given. D: Incorrect – Presidential assent is given after legislative passage, not before it.

Q. 46

Which part of the brain controls involuntary actions like heartbeat?

a) Cerebrum



b) Cerebellum



c) Medulla oblongata



d) Hypothalamus

**Explanation:****Answer:**

Medulla oblongata controls all involuntary actions like heartbeat, breathing, and blood pressure.

It works automatically without conscious control.

It is a part of the brain stem and is essential for survival.

Option Explanation:

Cerebrum → Controls thinking, memory, intelligence and voluntary actions like writing and speaking.

It does not control heartbeat or breathing.

Cerebellum → Controls balance, posture and coordination of muscles.

It helps in body movement but not in involuntary functions.

Medulla oblongata → Controls involuntary actions such as heartbeat, breathing and digestion.

It is the correct answer because it manages life-supporting functions.

Hypothalamus → Controls body temperature, hunger, thirst and hormone regulation.

It maintains body balance but does not directly control heartbeat.

Q. 47	The Franz Edelman Award is widely regarded as the: a) Oscar of Data Science ❌ b) Nobel Prize of Operations Research and Analytics ✅ c) Booker Prize of Technology ❌ d) Turing Award of Management Science ❌
Explanation:	Franz Edelman Award is considered the highest global recognition in Operations Research and Analytics, hence called the “Nobel Prize of OR”. Latest Franz Edelman Award Winner (2026): Microsoft 🏆 • Microsoft won the 2026 Franz Edelman Award for its work on cloud supply chain optimization and large-scale analytics system. (A): Incorrect – It is not related to film awards; “Oscar of Data Science” is just a nickname sometimes used but not official. (C): Incorrect – Booker Prize is a literary award, not related to technology. (D): Incorrect – Turing Award is for computer science, not management science.
Q. 48	Who is known as the “Queen of Thumri” in Indian classical music? a) Begum Akhtar ❌ b) Girija Devi ✅ c) Kishori Amonkar ❌ d) M.S. Subbulakshmi ❌
Explanation:	Answer: B. Girija Devi Girija Devi was a legendary Indian classical vocalist of the Banaras Gharana. She is widely known as the “Queen of Thumri” for her exceptional contribution to semi-classical music. She played a major role in popularizing Thumri, Dadra and other light classical forms. Begum Akhtar → Famous for Ghazal singing and also called “Mallika-e-Ghazal”, not Queen of Thumri Kishori Amonkar → Renowned Hindustani classical vocalist known for Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana style M.S. Subbulakshmi → Legendary Carnatic vocalist known for devotional music in South India

Q. 49	The term 'Navratnas' in public sector reform refers to: a) Public enterprises given full privatization ✗ b) Public enterprises granted autonomy for better performance ✓ c) Subsidy-driven rural firms ✗ d) Firms eligible for WTO support ✗
Explanation:	Answer: (b) Public enterprises granted autonomy for better performance Explanation: (a): Incorrect – Navratnas are not privatized firms, they still remain public sector enterprises. (b): Correct – Navratna status gives selected PSUs greater financial and operational autonomy to improve efficiency and performance. (c): Incorrect – It has no relation with subsidy-based rural firms. (d): Incorrect – Navratna classification is not related to WTO or international trade eligibility.

Q. 50	Consider the following statements regarding provincial architecture in medieval India: 1. Bengal and Jaunpur developed distinct architectural styles separate from the Delhi Sultanate. 2. Regional styles often blended Islamic structures with local artistic traditions. 3. Provincial styles remained completely uniform across all regions of India. Which of the above statements are correct? a) Only 1  b) Only 2  c) 1 and 2 only  d) All 1, 2 and 3 
Explanation:	Answer: (C) 1 and 2 only Explanation: (1): Correct – Bengal and Jaunpur developed their own distinct regional architectural styles influenced by but separate from the Delhi Sultanate. They show unique regional identity in design, arches, and ornamentation. (2): Correct – Provincial architecture often blended Islamic architectural features like domes and arches with local Indian artistic traditions, creating Indo-Islamic regional styles. (3): Incorrect – This statement is wrong because provincial architecture was not uniform. It varied widely across regions like Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa, and Jaunpur due to local influences. Conclusion: Only statements 1 and 2 are correct.

Q. 51

X, Y, and Z started a business by investing capital in the ratio 3 : 4 : 5. At the end of the year, the total profit earned is Rs. 1,44,000. What is the difference between the profit shares of Z and X?

- a) ₹12,000 
- b) ₹24,000 
- c) ₹36,000 
- d) ₹48,000 

Explanation:

$$X : Y : Z = 3 : 4 : 5$$

Difference between Z and X = $5 - 3 = 2$ parts

$$\text{Total parts} = 3 + 4 + 5 = 12$$

$$\text{Difference} = \frac{2}{12} \times 144000$$

$$= ₹24,000$$

Q. 52

A 4-digit number 45PQ is divisible by 3, 5 and 7. Find the value of $P^3 + Q^3$.

- a) 125 
- b) 133 
- c) 189 
- d) 126 

Explanation:

- $\text{LCM}(3, 5, 7) = 105$
- Multiple of 105 in range 4500–4599 = **4515**
- So, $P = 1, Q = 5$
- $P^3 + Q^3 = 1 + 125 = 126$

Final Answer: 126

Q. 53

A can complete a work in 12 days and B in 18 days. They work on alternate days starting with A. In how many days will the work be completed?

a) $14\frac{2}{3}$ days 

b) $14\frac{1}{3}$ days 

c) $15\frac{1}{3}$ days 

d) $15\frac{2}{3}$ days 

Explanation:

- A : B efficiency = $18 : 12 = 3 : 2$
 - Total work = $\text{LCM}(12, 18) = 36$ units
 - A's 1-day work = 3 units, B's 1-day work = 2 units
 - In 2 days (A + B) $\rightarrow$ work = $3 + 2 = 5$ units
 - In 14 days (7 cycles) $\rightarrow$ work done = $5 \times 7 = 35$ units
 - Remaining work = $36 - 35 = 1$ unit
 - A completes remaining $\rightarrow$ time = $\frac{1}{3}$ day
-  Final Answer: $14\frac{1}{3}$ days

Q. 54

From a bus depot, buses leave every 8 minutes and travel along a straight road at a speed of 32 km/hr. A traveller moving towards the depot along the same road meets the buses at regular intervals of 6 minutes. Find the speed of the traveller.

a) 11.66 km/hr



b) 9.33 km/hr



c) 10.67 km/hr



d) 9.45 km/hr

**Explanation:**

$$\text{Distance between buses} = 32 \times \left(\frac{8}{60}\right) = \frac{64}{15} \text{ km}$$

$$\text{Time between meetings} = \frac{\text{Distance}}{32 + v}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{6}{60} = \frac{\frac{64}{15}}{32 + v}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{10} = \frac{\frac{64}{15}}{32 + v}$$

$$\Rightarrow 32 + v = \frac{128}{3}$$

$$\Rightarrow v = \frac{32}{3} = \mathbf{10.67 \text{ km/hr}}$$

Final Answer: 10.67 km/hr

Q. 55

Simplify:

$$364 - \{142 - \{75 + (38 - (\frac{5}{4} + \frac{14}{8}))\}\}$$

a) 330 b) 332 c) 331 d) 334 

Explanation:

$$\frac{5}{4} + \frac{14}{8} = \frac{5}{4} + \frac{7}{4} = \frac{12}{4} = 3$$

So expression becomes:

$$364 - \{142 - \{75 + (38 - 3)\}\}$$

$$38 - 3 = 35$$

$$75 + 35 = 110$$

$$142 - 110 = 32$$

$$364 - 32 = 332$$

Final Answer: 332

Q. 56

Find the least value of $16\operatorname{cosec}^2\theta + 25\sin^2\theta$.a) 24 b) 16 c) 25 d) 40 

Explanation:

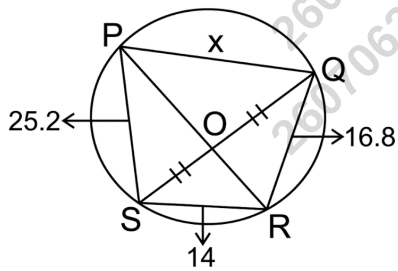
Minimum value of $a\sin^2\theta + b\operatorname{cosec}^2\theta = 2\sqrt{ab}$ (when $a > b$)Hence, minimum value of $16\operatorname{cosec}^2\theta + 25\sin^2\theta = 2\sqrt{(16 \times 25)} = 40$

Q. 57	x, y and z are divisible by 2, 3 and 4 respectively. What is the highest common factor (HCF) of 6x, 8y and 3z? a) At least 12  b) At least 36  c) At least 24  d) At least 18 
Explanation:	- Given: x divisible by 2 $\Rightarrow x = 2a$ y divisible by 3 $\Rightarrow y = 3b$ z divisible by 4 $\Rightarrow z = 4c$ - Now substitute: $6x = 6 \times 2a = 12a$ $8y = 8 \times 3b = 24b$ $3z = 3 \times 4c = 12c$ - So numbers become: 12a, 24b, 12c - HCF = common factor of all = 12
Q. 58	Pure ghee costs ₹128/kg. After adulterating it with vegetable oil costing ₹56/kg, a dishonest shopkeeper sells the mixture at the rate of ₹115/kg, thereby making a profit of 25%. In what ratio does he mix the two? a) 1 : 2  b) 2 : 1  c) 1 : 1  d) 2 : 3 
Explanation:	$CP \text{ of mixture} = \frac{115}{1.25} = 92$ Alligation: $128 - 92 : 92 - 56 = 36 : 36$ $= 1 : 1$ Final Answer: 1 : 1

Q. 59

PQRS is a cyclic quadrilateral in which $PQ = x$ cm, $QR = 16.8$ cm, $RS = 14$ cm and $PS = 25.2$ cm and PR and QS bisect each other. What is the value of x ?

- a) 19 
 b) 20 
 c) 21 
 d) 22 



As PR and SQ bisect each other at O.

In ΔPOS and ΔROQ ,
 $\angle POS = \angle ROQ$, $PO = RO$, $OS = QO$
 Thus, $\Delta POS \sim \Delta ROQ$

$$\frac{PO}{RO} = \frac{OS}{OQ} = \frac{PS}{QR} = \frac{25.2}{16.8} = \frac{3}{2} \quad \text{Similarly, } \Delta POQ \sim \Delta ROS$$

$$\text{So: } \frac{PQ}{SR} = \frac{3}{2} \Rightarrow \frac{x}{14} = \frac{3}{2} \Rightarrow x = 21$$

Short trick: As PR and SQ bisect each other at O,

$$\frac{PS}{QR} = \frac{PQ}{SR} \Rightarrow \frac{25.2}{16.8} = \frac{x}{14} \Rightarrow x = 21$$

Q. 60

The value of $\sin^2\left(\frac{2\pi}{3}\right) + \cos^2\left(\frac{5\pi}{6}\right) - \tan^2\left(\frac{3\pi}{4}\right)$ is:

- a) $3/2$ 
 b) $1/2$ 
 c) $7/2$ 
 d) $5/2$ 

Explanation:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \sin^2(2\pi/3) + \cos^2(5\pi/6) - \tan^2(3\pi/4) \\
 &= \sin^2 120^\circ + \cos^2 150^\circ - \tan^2 135^\circ \\
 &= (\sqrt{3}/2)^2 + \left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)^2 - (-1)^2 \\
 &= \frac{3}{4} + \frac{3}{4} - 1 \\
 &= \frac{6}{4} - 1 \\
 &= \frac{3}{2} - 1 \\
 &= \frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

Q. 61

A right prism has a triangular base with a side length of 8 cm and a corresponding height (altitude) of 5 cm. If the total height of the prism is 10 cm, find the volume of the prism.

- a) 210 cm^3 
 b) 200 cm^3 
 c) 220 cm^3 
 d) 180 cm^3 

Explanation:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Area of triangular base} &= \frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height} \\
 &= \frac{1}{2} \times 8 \times 5 \\
 &= 20 \text{ cm}^2
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Volume of prism} &= \text{Base area} \times \text{Prism height} \\
 &= 20 \times 10 \\
 &= 200 \text{ cm}^3
 \end{aligned}$$

Q. 62

A shop offers three successive discounts of 10%, 15% and 20% on a product. Find the single equivalent discount percentage that would result in the same final price.

- a) 36.78 % 
- b) 35.4 % 
- c) 38.8 % 
- d) 37.5 % 

Explanation:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Net price factor} &= \left(1 - \frac{10}{100}\right)\left(1 - \frac{15}{100}\right)\left(1 - \frac{20}{100}\right) \\ &= 0.9 \times 0.85 \times 0.8 \\ &= 0.612\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Equivalent discount} &= 1 - 0.612 \\ &= 0.388 = 38.8\%\end{aligned}$$

Final Answer: 38.8%

Q. 63

If $8x^4 = 11x^2 - 3$, $x > 1/\sqrt{2}$, then what is the value of $2x^2 - 3x - 6$?

- a) 5 
- b) 2 
- c) 3 
- d) -7 

Explanation:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Check } x = 1: \\ 8 \times 1^4 = 8, \quad 11 \times 1^2 - 3 = 8 \quad \checkmark\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Substitute } x = 1: \\ 2x^2 - 3x - 6 = 2 - 3 - 6 = -7\end{aligned}$$

Final Answer: -7

Q. 64

A library has a total of 80 books on a shelf. If 20 of those books are mystery novels, what percentage of the books on the shelf are mystery novels?

- a) 20% 
 b) 25% 
 c) 15% 
 d) 10% 

Explanation:

Mystery books = 20

Total books = 80

$$\text{Percentage} = \frac{20}{80} \times 100$$

$$= 25\%$$

Q. 65

The ratio of the incomes of Rama and Ganga is 4 : 3 and the ratio of their expenditures is 3 : 2. If each person saves ₹2,700, then find their expenditures, respectively.

- a) ₹8,100 and ₹5,000 
 b) ₹8,000 and ₹5,000 
 c) ₹8,100 and ₹5,400 
 d) ₹8,000 and ₹5,400 

Explanation:

Income ratio = 4:3, Expenditure ratio = 3:2, Savings = ₹2,700

Difference of ratio parts = 1 part = Savings = 2,700

Expenditures:

- Rama = 3 parts = $3 \times 2,700 = 8,100$
- Ganga = 2 parts = $2 \times 2,700 = 5,400$

Final Answer: ₹8,100 and ₹5,400 (Option c)

Q. 66

A piece of ribbon is 5.4 m long. It is cut into pieces of 0.9 m each. How many pieces?

- a) 4 
 b) 5 
 c) 6 
 d) 7 

Explanation:

Total length of ribbon = 5.4 m

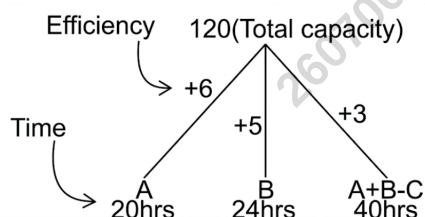
Length of each piece = 0.9 m

Number of pieces = Total length $\div$ Length of each piece
 $= 5.4 \div 0.9$
 $= 6$

Q. 67

Two pipes can fill a tank alone in 20 hours and 24 hours respectively and an outlet pipe can empty 20 gallons of water per hour. All three pipes working together can fill the same empty tank in 40 hours. What is the capacity of the tank?

- a) 300 gallons 
 b) 400 gallons 
 c) 500 gallons 
 d) 600 gallons 



Let, filling pipes A and B and outlet pipe = C

Explanation:

Efficiency $\rightarrow 120$ (Total capacity)

Time

A $\rightarrow 20$ hrs $\rightarrow +6$

B $\rightarrow 24$ hrs $\rightarrow +5$

A + B - C $\rightarrow 40$ hrs $\rightarrow +3$

Efficiency of outlet pipe = $6 + 5 - 3 = 8$ units

Capacity of tank = $\frac{120}{8} \times 20 = 300$ gallons

Q. 68

Three numbers are in the ratio 3:5:7. If their average is 60, what is the difference between the largest and the smallest number?

- a) 52 
- b) 48 
- c) 42 
- d) 56 

Explanation:

$$\text{Ratio} = 3 : 5 : 7$$

$$\text{Average} = 60$$

$$\text{So, sum of numbers} = 60 \times 3 = 180$$

$$\text{Sum of ratio} = 3 + 5 + 7 = 15$$

$$\text{Difference between largest and smallest} = 7 - 3 = 4 \text{ parts}$$

$$\text{Difference} = 180 \times \frac{4}{15} = 48$$

Q. 69

The area of a rectangle increases by 14 m^2 if its length is increased by 4 m and breadth is decreased by 2 m. If the length is decreased by 3 m and breadth is increased by 2 m, then its area decreases by 11 m^2 . What is the perimeter of the original rectangle (in m)?

- a) 70 m 
- b) 80 m 
- c) 60 m 
- d) 64 m 

Explanation:

$$(L + 4)(B - 2) = LB + 14 \Rightarrow -L + 2B = 11$$

$$(L - 3)(B + 2) = LB - 11 \Rightarrow 2L - 3B = -5$$

$$\text{Solve: } B = 17, L = 23$$

$$\text{Perimeter} = 2(L + B) = 2(23 + 17) = 80 \text{ m}$$

Final Answer: 80 m

Q. 70

In a circle of radius 10.5 cm, if the angle of a sector is $2\pi/3$, then the perimeter of the sector is (in cm): (Take $\pi = 22/7$)

a) 22 cm b) 43 cm c) 21 cm d) 27 cm **Explanation:**

Perimeter of sector = Arc length + $2r$

$$\text{Arc length} = r\theta$$

$$= 10.5 \times \left(\frac{2\pi}{3}\right)$$

$$= 10.5 \times \left(2 \times \frac{22}{7}\right) / 3 = 22 \text{ cm}$$

$$= 10.5 \times \left(\frac{44}{21}\right)$$

$$\text{Now perimeter} = 22 + 2 \times 10.5$$

$$= 22 + 21$$

$$= 43 \text{ cm}$$

Final Answer: 43 cm

Q. 71

A (x, 5), B (3, -4) and C (-6, y) are the three vertices of a triangle ABC. If (3.5, 4.5) is the centroid of the triangle, find the point (x + 3, y - 4).

a) (15.5, 8.5) b) (16.5, 9.5) c) (16.5, 8.5) d) (17.5, 7.5) **Explanation:**

Centroid formula:

$$\frac{x^1 + x^2 + x^3}{3}, \frac{y^1 + y^2 + y^3}{3}$$

$$\frac{x + 3 - 6}{3} = 3.5 \Rightarrow x = 13.5$$

$$\frac{5 - 4 + y}{3} = 4.5 \Rightarrow y = 12.5$$

Required point:

$$(x + 3, y - 4) = (16.5, 8.5)$$

Final Answer: (16.5, 8.5)

Q. 72

A student scored marks in 5 subjects: 72, 68, 74, 70, and one unknown subject. If his average is 71, what is the missing mark?

a) 70 b) 71 c) 72 d) 73 **Explanation:**

Let the missing mark = x

Average formula:

$$\text{Average} = \frac{\text{Sum of marks}}{\text{Number of subjects}}$$

$$71 = \frac{72 + 68 + 74 + 70 + x}{5}$$

$$71 \times 5 = 284 + x$$

$$355 = 284 + x$$

$$x = 355 - 284 = 71$$

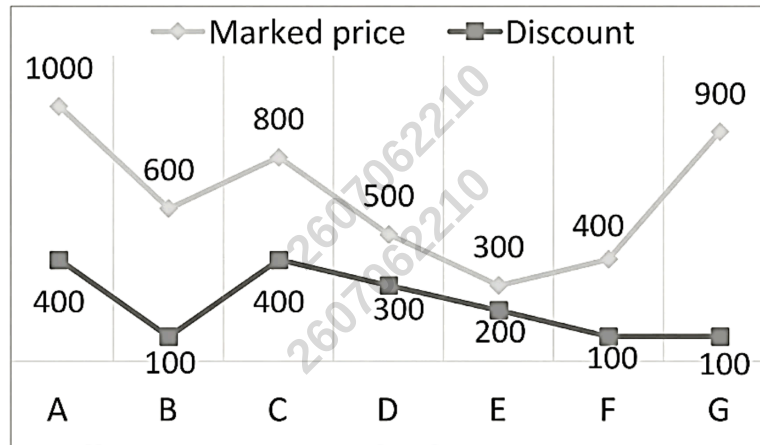
Final Answer: 71

Q. 73

The line chart given below shows the marked price and value of discount of 7 articles A, B, C, D, E, F and G.

Selling price = Marked price – Discount

Which of the following sequences is correct about the selling price of article A, B, C, D, E, F and G?



Selling price = Marked price - Discount

a) $G > A > B > C > F > E > D$

b) $A > G > B > C > F > D > E$

c) $G > A > B > C > F > D > E$

d) $A > G > B > C > F > E > D$

Selling price of A, B, C, D, E, F and G is 600, 500, 400, 200, 100, 300, 800 respectively.

Explanation:

Therefore, correct order of selling price of articles $\Rightarrow G > A > B > C > F > D > E$

Q. 74

A car travels at a constant speed of 60 km/h. How much distance will it cover in 3 hours?

- a) 120 km 
- b) 180 km 
- c) 240 km 
- d) 300 km 

Explanation:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Distance} &= \text{Speed} \times \text{Time} \\ &= 60 \times 3 \\ &= 180 \text{ km}\end{aligned}$$

Q. 75

If α , β and γ are the roots of the equation $6x^3 - 11x^2 + 6x - 1 = 0$, find the sum of products of roots and sum of roots.

- a) 2 
- b) $11/6$ 
- c) $19/6$ 
- d) $13/6$ 

Explanation:

Formula:

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma = -b/a, \alpha\beta\gamma = -d/a$$

$$\text{Given: } 6x^3 - 11x^2 + 6x - 1 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha + \beta + \gamma = \frac{11}{6} \Rightarrow \alpha\beta\gamma = 1/6$$

$$11/6 + 1/6 = 12/6 = 2$$

Q. 76	Find the part of the sentence that contains a grammatical error. The long-awaited judicial reform bill, which had been languishing in the upper house for months, was finally passed last week with few amendments than originally anticipated by them. a) The long-awaited judicial reform bill, which ✗ b) had been languishing in the upper house for ✗ c) months, was finally passed last week with ✗ d) few amendments than originally anticipated by them. ✓
Explanation:	The grammatical error lies in the phrase: "...with few amendments than originally anticipated..." Explanation: • The correct comparative form should be "fewer amendments than originally anticipated". • "Few" is used without comparison, while "fewer" is the proper comparative form when contrasting quantities. ✓ Corrected sentence: The long-awaited judicial reform bill, which had been languishing in the upper house for months, was finally passed last week with fewer amendments than originally anticipated by them.

Q. 77

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.

"Why did you skip the mandatory training session yesterday?" the departmental supervisor asked the intern.

- a) The supervisor asked the intern why did he skip the mandatory training session the previous day. 
- b) The supervisor asked the intern why he had skipped the mandatory training session the previous day. 
- c) The supervisor asked the intern why he skipped the mandatory training session the yesterday day. 
- d) The supervisor asked the intern why had he skipped the mandatory training session the yesterday day. 

Correct Answer: The supervisor asked the intern why he had skipped the mandatory training session the previous day

Explanation:

Explanation:

1. **Direct Speech Given**
 - "Why did you skip the mandatory training session yesterday?" the departmental supervisor asked the intern.
2. **Rule of Conversion to Indirect Speech**
 - **Question form** → becomes a statement in reported speech.
 - **Past tense ("did skip")** → changes to **past perfect ("had skipped")**.
 - **Yesterday** → changes to **the previous day**.
 - **Word order** → in indirect speech, the subject comes before the verb (not "why did he skip" but "why he had skipped").

Q. 78	Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The research team is analyzing the voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey. a) The voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey has been analyzed by the research team.  b) The voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey was being analyzed by the research team.  c) The voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey is being analyzed by the research team.  d) The voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey is analyzed by the research team daily. 
Explanation:	Correct Answer: The voluminous data collected during the survey is being analyzed by the research team Explanation: Original Sentence (Active Voice) "The research team is analyzing the voluminous data collected during the nationwide demographic survey." - Tense: Present Continuous (is analyzing). Passive Voice Rule for Present Continuous - Structure: is/are + being + past participle (V3). - Subject of active sentence ("The research team") becomes agent in passive. - Object ("the voluminous data") becomes subject in passive. Correct Transformation "The voluminous data collected during the survey is being analyzed by the research team."

Q. 79

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.

The practice of conducting negotiations between representatives of different sovereign states.

a) Diplomacy 

b) Autocracy 

c) Bureaucracy 

d) Oligarchy 

Correct Answer: Diplomacy

Explanation

- The phrase given: "The practice of conducting negotiations between representatives of different sovereign states."
- The one-word substitute is **Diplomacy** (कूटनीति / राजनय), which refers to the art and practice of managing international relations and negotiations between countries.
- Other options:
 - **Autocracy** (एकतंत्री शासन) – rule by one person with absolute power, unrelated.
 - **Bureaucracy** (नौकरशाही / प्रशासनिक तंत्र) – administrative system, not negotiations.
 - **Oligarchy** (कुलीनतंत्र / कुछ लोगों का शासन) – rule by a small group, unrelated.

Explanation:

Q. 80	Select the alternative which best expresses the meaning of the highlighted idiom. Her sudden resignation from the prestigious post came entirely out of the blue to the board. a) after long deliberation ✗ b) completely unexpectedly ✓ c) through official channels ✗ d) with prior notification ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: completely unexpectedly Explanation - The idiom "out of the blue" means suddenly and without warning; completely unexpected. - In the sentence, the board was surprised by her resignation, which came without prior indication. - Other options: - after long deliberation (लंबे विचार-विमर्श के बाद) ✗ opposite meaning. - through official channels (आधिकारिक माध्यमों से) ✗ unrelated. - with prior notification (पूर्व सूचना के साथ) ✗ opposite meaning. Thus, the correct meaning is completely unexpectedly (पूरी तरह अप्रत्याशित रूप से).

Q. 81	Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. OBSTINATE a) obdurate  b) tenacious  c) chaotic  d) compliant 
Explanation:	Correct Answer: compliant Explanation • Obstinate means stubborn, unwilling to change, rigid in opinion or behavior (हठी / ज़िद्दी). • Its antonym must express willingness to yield, flexibility, or readiness to agree. • The best opposite is Compliant (अनुकूल / आज्ञाकारी), meaning ready to agree or obey. • Other options: ◦ Obdurate (हठी / कठोर) – synonym, not antonym. ◦ Tenacious (दृढ़ / अटल) – synonym-like, persistence, not opposite. ◦ Chaotic (अराजक / अव्यवस्थित) – unrelated, not opposite of stubbornness. Thus, the correct antonym is Compliant (अनुकूल / आज्ञाकारी).

Q. 82

Select the most appropriate SYNONYM of the given word.

DOLDRUM

a) Boisterous



b) Roaring



c) Malaise



d) Scintillating



Correct Answer: Malaise

Explanation

Explanation:

- **Doldrum** means a state of inactivity, stagnation, or depression (निष्क्रियता / उदासी / ठहराव).
- **Synonyms:** stagnation, slump, malaise.
- **Other options:**
 - **Boisterous** (शोरगुल वाला / उच्छृंखल) – noisy, lively, opposite of doldrum.
 - **Roaring** (गर्जन / प्रचंड) – loud, energetic, opposite meaning.
 - **Scintillating** (चमकदार / तेजस्वी) – sparkling, brilliant, opposite of stagnation.

Q. 83

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank.

The corporate whistle-blower was praised for his _____ actions in exposing the widespread tax evasion scheme.

a) meritorious b) mercurial c) melancholic d) meticulous **Correct Answer:** meritorious**Explanation**

- The sentence praises the whistle-blower for his actions in exposing tax evasion.
- The most appropriate word is **Meritorious (योग्य / प्रशंसनीय)**, meaning **deserving praise or reward because of moral worth or excellence**.
- Other options:
 - **Mercurial (चंचल / अस्थिर)** – unpredictable, inconsistent, not suitable here.
 - **Melancholic (उदास / विषादपूर्ण)** – sad, gloomy, opposite of praise.
 - **Meticulous (सूक्ष्म / अत्यंत सावधान)** – careful and detailed, but does not directly convey praiseworthiness.

Thus, the correct choice is **Meritorious (योग्य / प्रशंसनीय)**.

Q. 84

Select the best alternative to replace the highlighted phrase.

If the local administration would have acted proactively, the water crisis could have been averted easily.

- a) should act proactively then 
- b) acted proactively in advance 
- c) would had acted proactively 
- d) had acted proactively 

Correct Answer: had acted proactively over time

Explanation:

Explanation:

1. **Original Sentence (Active)**
 - "If the local administration would have acted proactively, the water crisis could have been averted easily."
2. **Error Identification**
 - The phrase "**would have acted**" in the if-clause is incorrect.
 - In conditional grammar, the **if-clause** must use **past perfect tense**, not "would have."
 - Correct structure: **If + past perfect, would/could/might have + past participle.**
3. **Correct Usage**
 - "If the local administration **had acted proactively**, the water crisis could have been averted easily."
 - This follows the **third conditional rule** (hypothetical past situation + possible past result).

Q. 85	Select the best alternative to replace the highlighted phrase. The psychological effects of prolonged isolation are often more devastating than that of physical hardships. a) more devastating than those of ✓ b) more devastating than that off ✗ c) much devastating than those of ✗ d) much devastating than that of ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: more devastating than those of Explanation: Original Sentence “The psychological effects of prolonged isolation are often more devastating than that of physical hardships.” Error Identification - The word “effects” is plural. - Therefore, when comparing, the pronoun must also be plural (those) instead of singular (that). Correct Usage “...are often more devastating than those of physical hardships.” - This ensures proper agreement in number (plural → plural).

Q. 86

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.

A person who holds unorthodox, speculative, or dissenting religious opinions.

- a) bigot 
- b) glutton 
- c) lunatic 
- d) heretic 

Correct Answer: Heretic

Explanation

Explanation:

- The phrase "A person who holds unorthodox, speculative, or dissenting religious opinions" directly corresponds to **Heretic** (विधर्मी / मतभ्रष्ट).
- A **heretic** is someone who challenges or rejects established religious doctrines, often viewed as unorthodox or rebellious in matters of faith.
- Other options:
 - **Bigot** (कट्टरपंथी / संकीर्ण विचारधारा वाला) – intolerant person, but not specifically about religious dissent.
 - **Glutton** (पेटू / अत्यधिक खाने वाला) – someone who eats excessively, unrelated.
 - **Lunatic** (पागल / विक्षिप्त) – mentally unstable person, not about religious opinions.

Q. 87	Select the most appropriate SYNONYM of the given word. IMPECUNIOUS a) voracious ✗ b) luxurious ✗ c) penniless ✓ d) malicious ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: Penniless Explanation • Impecunious means having little or no money; poor (निर्धन / गरीब). • The closest synonym is Penniless (निर्धन / बिना पैसे का), which directly conveys the same meaning. • Other options: ◦ Voracious (भूखा / लालची) – extremely eager or hungry, unrelated. ◦ Luxurious (विलासी / आरामदायक) – opposite meaning, wealth and comfort. ◦ Malicious (दुर्भावनापूर्ण / हानिकारक) – evil intent, unrelated. Thus, the correct synonym is Penniless (निर्धन / बिना पैसे का).

Q. 88	Arrange the sentences in the most logical order to form a coherent paragraph. P: This autonomous system relies on deep learning networks to interpret structural anomalies dynamically. Q: Modern aerospace engineering demands highly sophisticated software to ensure immediate fault detection. R: Consequently, maintenance crews can preemptively address structural fatigue before catastrophic failure occurs. S: It achieves this by filtering real-time sensor data streaming directly from the aircraft's primary hull. a) QPSR  b) RSQP  c) QSRP  d) RQPS 
Explanation:	Best order: Q → P → S → R Explanation: - Q sets the context: modern aerospace engineering needs sophisticated software for immediate fault detection. - P introduces the solution: an autonomous system using deep learning to interpret structural anomalies dynamically. - S explains how the system works: by filtering real-time sensor data from the aircraft's hull. - R states the outcome: maintenance crews can preemptively address structural fatigue before catastrophic failure. This order follows a clear logical flow: need → solution → mechanism → result.

Q. 89	Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. EFFRONTERY a) jealousy ✗ b) timidity ✓ c) courtesy ✗ d) audacity ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: timidity Explanation • Effrontery means shameless boldness, insolent audacity, or rude behavior (निर्लज्जता / धृष्टता). • Its antonym must express shyness, hesitation, or lack of boldness. • The most appropriate opposite is Timidity (लज्जाशीलता / संकोच), which conveys fearfulness or lack of confidence. • Other options: ◦ Jealousy (ईर्ष्या) ✗ – unrelated to boldness. ◦ Courtesy (शिष्टाचार / विनम्रता) ✗ – politeness, not the direct opposite of shameless boldness. ◦ Audacity (धृष्टता / साहसिकता) ✗ – synonym, not antonym. Thus, the correct antonym is Timidity (लज्जाशीलता / संकोच).

Q. 90	Arrange the sentences in the most logical order to form a coherent paragraph. P: However, the introduction of synthetic pigments in the industrial era disrupted this traditional balance entirely. Q: Historically, natural dyes were extracted from local flora and fauna through highly resource-intensive processes. R: This paradigm shift democratized vibrant textiles but simultaneously triggered severe chemical pollution in rivers. S: Because production was constrained by nature, vibrant garments remained exclusive markers of royal wealth. a) QPRS  b) SQRP  c) QSPR  d) SRPQ 
Explanation:	Answer: QSPR Explanation: - Q introduces historical fact: natural dyes extracted from local flora/fauna through resource-intensive processes. - S follows logically: because production was constrained by nature, vibrant garments remained exclusive (explains consequence). - P continues: the industrial era's synthetic pigments disrupted that balance (marks change). - R concludes: the shift democratized vibrant textiles but caused severe chemical pollution (states outcomes of the change). So the coherent paragraph order is Q → S → P → R

Q. 91

Select the most appropriate **ANTONYM** of the given word.**SANCTIMONIOUS**a) forthright b) hypocritical c) artificial d) passionate **Correct Answer:** forthright**Explanation**

- **Sanctimonious** means **pretending to be morally superior, hypocritically pious or self-righteous** (पाखंडी / ढोंगी धार्मिकता दिखाने वाला).
- Its antonym must express **genuine, honest, and straightforward behavior without hypocrisy**.
- The best opposite is **Forthright** (स्पष्टवादी / ईमानदार), meaning direct, sincere, and free from pretension.
- Other options:
 - **Hypocritical** (पाखंडी / कपटी)  – actually a synonym, not antonym.
 - **Artificial** (कृत्रिम / बनावटी)  – fake, but not the precise opposite of sanctimonious.
 - **Passionate** (उत्साही / भावुक)  – unrelated to hypocrisy or moral pretension.

Thus, the correct antonym is **Forthright** (स्पष्टवादी / ईमानदार).

Q. 92	Select the most appropriate SYNONYM of the given word. CONTUMACIOUS a) rebellious ✓ b) sagacious ✗ c) tenacious ✗ d) parsimonious ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: rebellious Explanation - Contumacious means stubbornly or willfully disobedient to authority; rebellious (हठी / विद्रोही / आज्ञा न मानने वाला). - The closest synonym is Rebellious (विद्रोही / विरोधी), which conveys resistance to control or authority. - Other options: - Sagacious (बुद्धिमान / विवेकशील) ✗ – wise, unrelated. - Tenacious (दृढ़ / अटल) ✗ – persistent, not necessarily disobedient. - Parsimonious (कंजूस / अत्यधिक मितव्ययी) ✗ – miserly, unrelated. Thus, the correct synonym is Rebellious (विद्रोही / विरोधी).

Q. 93

Select the alternative which best expresses the meaning of the highlighted idiom.

The project manager decided to take the bull by the horns and confront the budget deficit immediately.

- a) delay the final decision indefinitely ✗
- b) shift the responsibility to subordinates ✗
- c) avoid an uncomfortable issue completely ✗
- d) deal with a difficult situation directly ✓

Correct Answer: deal with a difficult situation directly

Explanation

Explanation:

- The idiom **"take the bull by the horns"** means to **face a problem boldly and deal with it directly without hesitation.**
- In the sentence, the project manager confronts the **budget deficit immediately**, which matches the meaning of the idiom.
- Other options:
 - **delay the final decision indefinitely** (निर्णय को अनिश्चितकाल तक टालना) ✗ opposite meaning.
 - **shift the responsibility to subordinates** (जिम्मेदारी अधीनस्थों पर डालना) ✗ unrelated.
 - **avoid an uncomfortable issue completely** (कठिन मुद्दे से पूरी तरह बचना) ✗ opposite meaning.
 - **deal with a difficult situation directly** (कठिन परिस्थिति का सीधे सामना करना) ✓ correct.

Q. 94	Find the part of the sentence that contains a grammatical error. The committee preferred investing the surplus funds in infrastructure projects rather than to keep them in a low-yield savings account. a) The committee preferred investing the surplus funds ✗ b) in infrastructure projects rather than to keep ✓ c) them in a low-yield savings account during ✗ d) this highly volatile and unpredictable fiscal quarter. ✗
Explanation:	Correct Answer: in infrastructure projects rather than to keep Explanation: Original Sentence "The committee preferred investing the surplus funds in infrastructure projects rather than to keep them in a low-yield savings account." Error Identification - The highlighted phrase "rather than to keep" is incorrect because it breaks the rule of parallel structure. - The first part uses a gerund (investing), so the second part must also use a gerund (keeping), not an infinitive (to keep). Correct Usage - The sentence should be: "...preferred investing the surplus funds in infrastructure projects rather than keeping them in a low-yield savings account."

Q. 95

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank.

The diplomatic relations between the two neighboring nations have deteriorated to the point of being _____.

- a) irresponsible 
- b) indispensable 
- c) indestructible 
- d) irreconcilable 

Correct Answer: irreconcilable

Explanation

- The sentence describes diplomatic relations that have **deteriorated to the point where they cannot be resolved or reconciled**.
- The most appropriate word is **Irreconcilable** (असमाधेय / मेल न खाने योग्य), meaning **impossible to bring into agreement or harmony**.
- Other options:
 - **Irresponsible** (गैर-जिम्मेदार) – careless, unrelated.
 - **Indispensable** (अनिवार्य / अपरिहार्य) – essential, opposite meaning.
 - **Indestructible** (अविनाशी / नष्ट न होने वाला) – cannot be destroyed, irrelevant.

Thus, the correct choice is **Irreconcilable** (असमाधेय / मेल न खाने योग्य).

Q. 96

Read the following passage carefully and answer the given questions:

The rise of algorithmic curation has fundamentally altered the architecture of human attention, shifting the locus of cognitive control from the individual to centralized digital infrastructures. Historically, information scarcity required active curation, a deliberate process wherein knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning. In the contemporary attention economy, however, the paradigm has inverted; an unprecedented surplus of data necessitates automated filters that predict user preferences with uncanny precision. These feedback loops create self-reinforcing echo chambers that not only mimic existing cognitive biases but actively entrench them, subtly shifting an individual's worldview by systematically purging contrarian perspectives. Consequently, the democratic ideal of a shared public square, built upon a foundation of mutually agreed-upon facts, is steadily being replaced by fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.

This systemic balkanization of reality poses a profound threat to institutional trust and collective problem-solving. When algorithms prioritize engagement over veracity—capitalizing on primal emotional triggers like outrage and tribalism—the systemic integrity of public discourse degrades rapidly. Intellectual nuance is discarded in favor of polarizing caricatures, reducing complex socio-economic debates to binary, zero-sum conflicts. Mitigating this cognitive capture requires a multi-pronged approach that transcends the simplistic demands for user self-regulation. Instead, it demands structural transparency from technology conglomerates, algorithmic audits by independent regulatory bodies, and a fundamental reassessment of the metrics that define success in the digital marketplace. Until the underlying economic incentives change, the digital public square will remain an engine for cognitive divergence.

Q- Which of the most appropriate phrases best captures the primary central theme of the provided passage?

- a) The dangerous degradation of public discourse via algorithmic feedback mechanisms. 
- b) The inevitable historical transition from data scarcity to unprecedented data surplus. 
- c) The urgent need for immediate user self-regulation within digital marketplaces. 
- d) The commercial exploitation of basic human emotions by corporate media conglomerates. 

Correct Answer: The dangerous degradation of public discourse via algorithmic feedback mechanisms

Explanation:

1. **Central Theme of Passage**

- The passage emphasizes how **algorithmic curation** and **feedback loops** reshape human attention and entrench biases.
- This leads to **echo chambers, fragmented realities**, and ultimately the **degradation of democratic discourse**.

2. **Why Option 1 is Correct**

- "The dangerous degradation of public discourse via algorithmic feedback mechanisms" directly captures the passage's main concern:
 - Algorithms prioritize **engagement over truth**.
 - They exploit **emotional triggers** like outrage and tribalism.
 - They erode **institutional trust** and **collective problem-solving**.

Q. 97

Read the following passage carefully and answer the given questions:

The rise of algorithmic curation has fundamentally altered the architecture of human attention, shifting the locus of cognitive control from the individual to centralized digital infrastructures. Historically, information scarcity required active curation, a deliberate process wherein knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning. In the contemporary attention economy, however, the paradigm has inverted; an unprecedented surplus of data necessitates automated filters that predict user preferences with uncanny precision. These feedback loops create self-reinforcing echo chambers that not only mimic existing cognitive biases but actively entrench them, subtly shifting an individual's worldview by systematically purging contrarian perspectives. Consequently, the democratic ideal of a shared public square, built upon a foundation of mutually agreed-upon facts, is steadily being replaced by fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.

This systemic balkanization of reality poses a profound threat to institutional trust and collective problem-solving. When algorithms prioritize engagement over veracity—capitalizing on primal emotional triggers like outrage and tribalism—the systemic integrity of public discourse degrades rapidly. Intellectual nuance is discarded in favor of polarizing caricatures, reducing complex socio-economic debates to binary, zero-sum conflicts. Mitigating this cognitive capture requires a multi-pronged approach that transcends the simplistic demands for user self-regulation. Instead, it demands structural transparency from technology conglomerates, algorithmic audits by independent regulatory bodies, and a fundamental reassessment of the metrics that define success in the digital marketplace. Until the underlying economic incentives change, the digital public square will remain an engine for cognitive divergence.

Q- According to the first paragraph, how has the transition from information scarcity to surplus impacted curation?

- a) It expanded the democratic public square by offering a broader array of facts. 
- b) It eliminated cognitive biases by systematically presenting balanced and contrarian perspectives online. 
- c) It compelled individual knowledge seekers to thoroughly navigate static digital landscapes daily. 
- d) It shifted the burden of curation from active human selectors to predictive automated systems. 

Correct Answer: It shifted the burden of curation from active human selectors to predictive automated systems

Explanation:

Explanation:

1. **Passage Context**

- The first paragraph contrasts **historical scarcity of information** (which required humans to actively curate knowledge) with the **modern surplus of data** (which requires automated filters).

2. **Key Transition**

- Earlier: knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning → **active human curation**.
- Now: automated filters predict user preferences with precision → **algorithmic curation**.

Q. 98

Read the following passage carefully and answer the given questions:

The rise of algorithmic curation has fundamentally altered the architecture of human attention, shifting the locus of cognitive control from the individual to centralized digital infrastructures. Historically, information scarcity required active curation, a deliberate process wherein knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning. In the contemporary attention economy, however, the paradigm has inverted; an unprecedented surplus of data necessitates automated filters that predict user preferences with uncanny precision. These feedback loops create self-reinforcing echo chambers that not only mimic existing cognitive biases but actively entrench them, subtly shifting an individual's worldview by systematically purging contrarian perspectives. Consequently, the democratic ideal of a shared public square, built upon a foundation of mutually agreed-upon facts, is steadily being replaced by fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.

This systemic balkanization of reality poses a profound threat to institutional trust and collective problem-solving. When algorithms prioritize engagement over veracity—capitalizing on primal emotional triggers like outrage and tribalism—the systemic integrity of public discourse degrades rapidly. Intellectual nuance is discarded in favor of polarizing caricatures, reducing complex socio-economic debates to binary, zero-sum conflicts. Mitigating this cognitive capture requires a multi-pronged approach that transcends the simplistic demands for user self-regulation. Instead, it demands structural transparency from technology conglomerates, algorithmic audits by independent regulatory bodies, and a fundamental reassessment of the metrics that define success in the digital marketplace. Until the underlying economic incentives change, the digital public square will remain an engine for cognitive divergence.

Q- The author uses the term "zero-sum conflicts" in the second paragraph most likely to imply that:

- a) modern socio-economic issues are fundamentally simple and lack any true intellectual nuance. 
- b) public debates are increasingly framed such that one side's gain is strictly another's loss. 
- c) mathematical algorithms have successfully optimized the processing of complex public discourses. 
- d) financial incentives have completely eliminated the presence of outrage within digital spaces. 

Correct Answer: Public debates are increasingly framed such that one side's gain is strictly another's loss

Explanation:

1. **Context from Passage**

- In the second paragraph, the author explains that algorithms **discard intellectual nuance** and reduce debates into **polarizing caricatures**.
- Complex socio-economic issues are simplified into **binary conflicts**.

2. **Meaning of "Zero-Sum Conflicts"**

- A **zero-sum conflict** means that **one side's gain automatically equals another side's loss**.
- There is no room for compromise, shared benefit, or nuanced resolution.

Explanation:

3. **Option Analysis**

- **Option 1: "Modern socio-economic issues are fundamentally simple and lack any true intellectual nuance."** ✗
 - Wrong; the issues are complex, but algorithms present them as simple binaries.
- **Option 2: "Public debates are increasingly framed such that one side's gain is strictly another's loss."** ✓
 - Correct; matches the meaning of "zero-sum conflicts" and the passage's description.
- **Option 3: "Mathematical algorithms have successfully optimized the processing of complex public discourses."** ✗
 - Wrong; algorithms degrade discourse, not optimize it.
- **Option 4: "Financial incentives have completely eliminated the presence of outrage within digital spaces."** ✗
 - Opposite; outrage is exploited, not eliminated.

Q. 99

Read the following passage carefully and answer the given questions:

The rise of algorithmic curation has fundamentally altered the architecture of human attention, shifting the locus of cognitive control from the individual to centralized digital infrastructures. Historically, information scarcity required active curation, a deliberate process wherein knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning. In the contemporary attention economy, however, the paradigm has inverted; an unprecedented surplus of data necessitates automated filters that predict user preferences with uncanny precision. These feedback loops create self-reinforcing echo chambers that not only mimic existing cognitive biases but actively entrench them, subtly shifting an individual's worldview by systematically purging contrarian perspectives. Consequently, the democratic ideal of a shared public square, built upon a foundation of mutually agreed-upon facts, is steadily being replaced by fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.

This systemic balkanization of reality poses a profound threat to institutional trust and collective problem-solving. When algorithms prioritize engagement over veracity—capitalizing on primal emotional triggers like outrage and tribalism—the systemic integrity of public discourse degrades rapidly. Intellectual nuance is discarded in favor of polarizing caricatures, reducing complex socio-economic debates to binary, zero-sum conflicts. Mitigating this cognitive capture requires a multi-pronged approach that transcends the simplistic demands for user self-regulation. Instead, it demands structural transparency from technology conglomerates, algorithmic audits by independent regulatory bodies, and a fundamental reassessment of the metrics that define success in the digital marketplace. Until the underlying economic incentives change, the digital public square will remain an engine for cognitive divergence.

Q- Based on the passage, which of the following actions would the author most strongly support to combat cognitive capture?

- a) Censoring emotionally volatile user content that deliberately promotes polarization and social tribalism. 
- b) Launching comprehensive public awareness campaigns aimed at improving individual user self-regulation 
- c) Mandating independent algorithmic audits alongside enforcing structural transparency for tech giants. 
- d) Maximizing engagement metrics to ensure that diverse socio-economic viewpoints are thoroughly represented. 

Correct Answer: Mandating independent algorithmic audits alongside enforcing structural transparency for tech giants

Explanation:

1. **Passage Context**

- The author criticizes algorithms for prioritizing **engagement over truth**, exploiting **outrage and tribalism**, and degrading **public discourse**.
- He rejects simplistic reliance on **user self-regulation**.

2. **Proposed Solution in Passage**

- The author calls for:
 - **Structural transparency** from technology conglomerates.
 - **Algorithmic audits** by independent regulatory bodies.
 - **Reassessment of success metrics** in the digital marketplace.
- These are systemic, structural reforms—not censorship or user-only responsibility.

Explanation:

Q. 100

Read the following passage carefully and answer the given questions:

The rise of algorithmic curation has fundamentally altered the architecture of human attention, shifting the locus of cognitive control from the individual to centralized digital infrastructures. Historically, information scarcity required active curation, a deliberate process wherein knowledge seekers navigated physical or static digital landscapes to synthesize meaning. In the contemporary attention economy, however, the paradigm has inverted; an unprecedented surplus of data necessitates automated filters that predict user preferences with uncanny precision. These feedback loops create self-reinforcing echo chambers that not only mimic existing cognitive biases but actively entrench them, subtly shifting an individual's worldview by systematically purging contrarian perspectives. Consequently, the democratic ideal of a shared public square, built upon a foundation of mutually agreed-upon facts, is steadily being replaced by fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.

This systemic balkanization of reality poses a profound threat to institutional trust and collective problem-solving. When algorithms prioritize engagement over veracity—capitalizing on primal emotional triggers like outrage and tribalism—the systemic integrity of public discourse degrades rapidly. Intellectual nuance is discarded in favor of polarizing caricatures, reducing complex socio-economic debates to binary, zero-sum conflicts. Mitigating this cognitive capture requires a multi-pronged approach that transcends the simplistic demands for user self-regulation. Instead, it demands structural transparency from technology conglomerates, algorithmic audits by independent regulatory bodies, and a fundamental reassessment of the metrics that define success in the digital marketplace. Until the underlying economic incentives change, the digital public square will remain an engine for cognitive divergence.

Q- Select the most appropriate SYNONYM for the word "BALKANIZATION" as it is contextually utilized in the second paragraph.

- a) modernization 
- b) stabilization 
- c) unification 
- d) fragmentation 

Correct Answer: fragmentation

Explanation

Explanation:

- **Balkanization** (बाल्कनीकरण) refers to the **division or fragmentation of a region, system, or community into smaller, often hostile or non-cooperative units.**
- In the passage, it is used to describe how the digital public square is breaking into **fragmented, hyper-personalized realities.**
- Therefore, the most appropriate synonym is **Fragmentation (खंडन / विखंडन).**
- Other options:
 - **Modernization (आधुनिकीकरण)** ✗ – unrelated, opposite sense.
 - **Stabilization (स्थिरीकरण)** ✗ – opposite meaning, implies unity and balance.
 - **Unification (एकीकरण)** ✗ – opposite of fragmentation.

Thus, the correct synonym is **Fragmentation (खंडन / विखंडन).**